PARTNERS of the AMERICAS
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Healthy Workplace Policy (Final)

Effective March 1, 2022

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Healthy Workplace Policy (Final)

Purpose

Partners of the Americas is implementing this Healthy Workplace Policy for all employees in an effort to protect the health and safety of everyone at POA. This policy is based on guidance from the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC), the U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission, and all other laws applicable to the District of Columbia. This policy is an integral part of POA's overall strategy and commitment to maintaining a safe and healthy workplace and is subject to change as circumstances and applicable guidance require. "POA Office" is defined in this policy as the Home & Field Office, or any location designated as an official POA location or event. These include, but are not limited to, training, team meetings, organizational social events, stakeholder external meetings, etc. Each Field Office will need to adapt this policy to comply with local health authorities and/or legal requirements.

Transmission of Communicable Diseases

Considering the COVID-19 pandemic, and the fact that the seasonal influenza (flu) virus is also widespread, we are taking proactive steps to address several business concerns. First and foremost, we want to maintain a safe workplace and encourage and/or adopt practices protecting the health of employees, clients, visitors, or others. We also want to ensure the continuity of business operations during this pandemic.

We ask all employees to cooperate in taking steps to reduce the transmission of communicable diseases in the workplace. Employees are reminded of the following:

- Stay home when you are sick.
- Wash your hands frequently with warm, soapy water for at least 20 seconds.
- Cover your mouth with tissues whenever you sneeze and discard used tissues in the trash.
- Avoid people who are sick with respiratory symptoms.
- Clean frequently touched surfaces.
- Get vaccinated against COVID-19 and the seasonal flu, if possible.

It is critical that employees do not report to work while they are experiencing respiratory symptoms such as fever, cough, shortness of breath, sore throat, runny or stuffy nose, body aches, headache, chills, or fatigue. Currently, the CDC recommends that employees remain at home until they are free of fever for at least 24 hours without the use of fever-reducing medications, the employee's symptoms have improved and at least five (5) days have passed since the symptoms first appeared.

Many times, with the best of intentions, employees report to work even though they feel ill. POA provides paid sick time and other benefits to compensate employees who are unable to work due to illness. Employees who report to work ill will be sent home in accordance with these health guidelines. Employees who are expecting clients, visitors, or others must confirm either verbal or written acknowledgment that the visitor has assessed their health on the day of the visit.

POA Offices will provide alcohol-based hand sanitizers throughout the workplace and in common areas. Employees are responsible for cleaning their personal space with provided supplies. Provided supplies may include cleaning sprays and wipes to clean and disinfect frequently touched objects and surfaces such as telephones, keyboards, and/or office

doorknobs. Conference and meeting rooms are to be cleaned and sanitized after each use. Meeting organizers should wipe down the conference table, chair armrest, phone, and any other high-touch surfaces. POA Offices has daily cleaning services to be conducted after office hours and scheduled quarterly deep cleanings. POA Offices will provide face coverings to employees, and/ or visitors, who request them at no cost.

Vaccination

Vaccination is the key element in a multi-layered approach to protect our employees. According to the CDC and other public health bodies, the flu shot and approved COVID-19 vaccines have been found safe and highly effective at preventing communicable diseases from spreading from person to person and preventing serious illness and death in individuals who do contract COVID-19. The CDC also has published data showing that vaccinated individuals are less likely to transmit the virus to others.

Consistent with CDC guidance, and to prevent the spread of the flu or COVID-19, POA strongly encourages all employees who are eligible, able, and can safely receive a vaccine to get vaccinated. While not all positions are required to travel, positions with travel requirements will be required to be vaccinated against COVID-19 per CDC and TSA guidance and provide a copy to HR.

Reasonable Accommodations

Any POA employee who is unable to obtain a COVID-19 vaccination for a medical or disability-related reason (including pregnancy, childbirth, a related medical condition, or breastfeeding) or due to a sincerely held religious belief, must submit a written request for an accommodation to Human Resources, with supporting documentation. POA is committed to engaging in good faith in a timely and interactive process and providing reasonable accommodation to employees when legally required.

Conclusion

POA is committed to developing and sustaining a healthy workplace for all employees. A healthy workplace requires organizational-wide participation, and it is a responsibility shared between employees and management. At POA, all employees are encouraged to exercise control of their own health and to participate in preventive measures to combat the transmission of communicable diseases.